1. Purpose

To establish a consistent, documented procedure for collecting, labeling, storing, and disposing the retention samples of food served at the company. Daily food samples are retained for testing or reference in case of safety complaints, illness reports, or regulatory inspections.

2. Scope

It strictly governs the mandatory collection, handling, labeling, storage, and disposal of food retention samples for all consumable items prepared, handled, or served. Specifically, this procedure encompasses all hotpot soup and broth bases,sauces such as signature Jiang Nan sauces or the sauce bar items, and all raw or prepped protein selections served for hotpot and grill service. It also covers fresh produce such as spinach, lettuce, and corn; ice cream and halo-halo liquid mixtures alongside their respective toppings and ingredients; house beverages including plum juice, orange juice, and complimentary service water; and edible ice used for drinks and food display. Compliance with this procedure is mandatory without exception across all branch locations on every operating day, regardless of guest volume or daily sales.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Commissary Supervisor

Shall oversee and manage the daily collection, labeling, and recording of retention samples for all batch-prepared broths, paste or sauces, and raw or prepped ingredients processed at the commissary. Shall verify that all commissary sample containers are sterile, filled to required volume limits, and accurately recorded in the commissary log before storing. Also monitor commissary retention storage temperatures twice daily to maintain mandatory storage conditions at or below -18°C.

3.2. Commissary Assistant

Shall collect, package, and label representative retention samples from every commissary production batch using sanitized equipment. Shall transfer labeled retention samples immediately into designated retention freezers under the direct supervision of the Commissary Supervisor. Shall maintain cleanliness, organization, and correct chronological rotation within the commissary retention freezer.

3.3. Restaurant Manager

Shall hold overall accountability for branch-wide adherence to food retention sampling standards across all shifts. Shall audit and sign off on completed daily Food Retention Sample Logs to ensure 100% compliance. Shall maintain secure, retention storage dedicated exclusively to retention samples.

3.4. Shift Manager

Shall perform shift-level audits of sample logs, storage temperatures, and physical inventory on every operating day. Shall report any missed samples, temperature deviations, or protocol non-conformances directly to the Restaurant Manager. Shall supervise the safe and documented disposal of expired samples once the mandatory 5-7 days holding period has elapsed.

3.5. Kitchen Captain

Shall direct Back of House employees on required sample portions, and sanitary handling practices. Shall ensure required kitchen items—including hotpot soups, signature sauces, sliced proteins, and produce—are sampled without exception. Shall verify that all sample bags are securely sealed, leak-proof, and fully labeled before storage.

3.6. Back of House (BOH) Employee

Shall collect daily retention samples for all hotpot soup bases, prepped proteins, and fresh produce (including spinach, lettuce, and corn) using clean, sanitized utensils. Shall label every sample container immediately with item name, batch ID, collection date, time, shift, and employee signature. Shall place labeled samples into the designated food retention freezer without delay.

3.7. Front of House (FOH) Employee

Shall collect daily retention samples for all FOH items, including signature sauces and sauce bar items, plum juice, orange juice, complimentary service water, ice cream, halo-halo bases and toppings, and edible ice. Shall use sanitized scoops and sterile techniques to collect ice and liquid samples without touching inner container surfaces. Shall complete required container labels and place FOH samples directly into assigned retention freezer storage.

3.8. Area Manager

Shall conduct unannounced monthly compliance checks across all assigned branch locations to evaluate retention sampling performance. They inspect branch sample logbooks, storage temperature records, and stored physical samples during regular branch audits. Shall issue corrective action mandates for any identified non-compliance or procedural gaps within their store network.

3.9. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall own, maintain, and update IKQA-SOP#011 to ensure alignment with current food safety standards and regulatory requirements. Shall perform random branch audits, review non-conformance reports, and track corrective action execution. Shall retrieve, secure, and transport retention samples to accredited third-party laboratories during food safety investigations or guest illness reports.

3.10. Learning & Development (L&D) Manager

Shall integrate IKQA-SOP#011 guidelines into standardized onboarding programs for all new employees. They collaborate with QA to design, schedule, and execute mandatory biannual refresher training sessions. And to maintain complete employee training records and evaluate employees competency regarding retention sample execution.

4. Definition of Terms

- **Chain of Custody:** A documented, unbroken record of who collected, stored, handled, and disposed of a retention sample, with signatures/initials at each step.
- **Cross-Contamination:** The accidental transfer of harmful microorganisms or contaminants from utensils, hands, or surfaces into the food sample.
- **Food Retention Sample:** A representative portion of prepared food, beverage, or ingredient retained under controlled frozen conditions for future microbiological or chemical testing in response to customer complaints or inspections.
- **Retention Period:** The required 5-7 days holding duration during which samples must remain safely stored before disposal.
- **Sampling Point:** The specific moment in preparation when a retention sample must be taken (defined per category in Section 6)

5. Principles

5.1. Representativeness

Every retention sample accurately mirrors the exact physical, chemical, and organoleptic characteristics of the food, ice, and beverage items actually served to guests on each operating day. Samples are drawn directly from the active batch of prepared food, fresh produce, or beverage service lines to eliminate discrepancies between customer meals and test specimens. Maintaining this exact alignment ensures that any subsequent microbiological, chemical, or allergen analysis yields valid diagnostic results reflecting true guest exposure conditions.

5.2. Sanitary Integrity

All retention samples are collected using strictly sterile utensils, sanitized ladles, and single-use food-grade bags or containers to prevent any introduction of external microbial contaminants. Employees executing the collection process adhere strictly to handling protocols, including proper hand hygiene and single-use glove utilization. Direct hand contact with food-contact surfaces or sample interiors is strictly prohibited to protect test validity and prevent cross-contamination from environmental sources.

5.3. Complete Traceability

Every individual sample container is fully identifiable by displaying a clear, moisture-resistant label detailing the branch location, collection date, exact time of collection, specific item name, operating shift, and the signature of the collector. Accompanying documentation on daily logs links every stored sample batch to its precise origin, preparation source, and handling history. This unbroken chain of information allows QA and management to instantly trace, audit, and verify any sample throughout its mandatory 5-7 days holding lifecycle.

5.4. Universal Compliance

Daily food retention sample collection is strictly compulsory across all operating branch locations and commissary without exception. This requirement is enforced uniformly regardless of daily sales volume, guest foot traffic, holiday schedules, or operational constraints. Any failure to execute daily sample collections is treated as a direct breach of food safety standards subject to immediate corrective action and administrative review.

6. Complete Traceability

This section defines the step-by-step operational workflows required to systematically collect representative retention samples across all Jiang Nan Hotpot restaurant locations and the central commissary. All employees must execute these sampling routines at their designated sampling points during every operating shift, without exception. Adherence to these step-by-step handling, portioning, and transfer techniques safeguards sanitary integrity, prevents cross-contamination, and maintains an unbroken chain of custody for all retention samples collected.

Category	Sample Point	Suggested Sample Size	Retention Period	Standard Condition
Soup / Broth Stock *Mushroom, Mild Spicy, Spicy, Original, Bone broth*	Holding pot / Kettle prior dispatching to dining area	100 - 150mL	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C) or Frozen (≤ -18°C)

Category	Sample Point	Suggested Sample Size	Retention Period	Standard Condition
Spices *Chili Flakes, dried herbs, etc.*		50g	5-7 days (or batch duration)	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed — Keep it in an ambient (25°C) & dry
Sauce Bar Ingredients *Minced garlic, chopped scallions, cilantro, spring onions, chili oil, sesame paste*	Prep station prior to display / Sauce bar service tray	100g	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)
Sauces	From the first batch of each sauce prepared and set out for service each day.	100g per sauce type offered that day	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)
Meats *beef, pork, chicken, seafood, etc.*	Slicing Station before customer serving	100g per protein type	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Frozen (≤ -18°C)
Ball Items *Fish roe, Cheese Ball, Crab Roe, etc.*	Prep counter prior to serving	100g (approx. 2-4 pcs) per type	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed
Veggies *Spinach, Lettuce, Corn, etc.*	Washing and trimming station	100g	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)
Ice Cream Mixture *Soft serve ice cream mix*	Prep container before loading	100mL	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C) or Keep Frozen (≤ -18°C)
Halo Halo Mixture *Evaporated /condensed milk mix, ube milk base*	Milk dispenser jug.	100mL	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerant and Keep Frozen (≤ -18°C)ed (0-4°C)
Halo - Halo ingredients *Sweetened beans, macapuno,leche flan,nata, etc.*	From the first portioned set of individual Halo-Halo ingredients (ex:	100g per item	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)

Category	Sample Point	Suggested Sample Size	Retention Period	Standard Condition
	ube, leche flan, sago, beans) prepared for service each day.			
Service Water *Filtered drinking water, service jug water*	From the water station/pitcher used for guest service, drawn at the start of each service day.	250 mL	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic bottle and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)
Juice *Plum and Orange*	From the first batch/pitcher of each juice flavor prepared or opened for service each day.	100mL	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic bottle and Keep Refrigerated (0-4°C)
Ice *Tube ice for drinks*	From the first batch of ice used for service and drinks each day, taken from the ice storage bin or iced delivered.	100g	5-7 days	Sterile, Leak-Proof, Food-Grade PE Plastic, Vacuum-Sealed and Keep Frozen (≤ -18°C)

7. Labeling, Disposal and Storage Requirements

7.1. Labeling Standard

Every retention sample container must be labeled at the time the sample is taken, with the following information written clearly (waterproof non-toxic marker or pre-printed label):

- Item name (e.g., "Angus Beef", "Pork Soup", "Jiang Nan Sauce")
- Date and time collected
- Batch / Lot No: (e.g., Batch 01, Batch 02)
- Collected By: Employee and signature who collected the sample
- Retention End By : The retention period when the item can be disposed
- Signature of Manager of Duty (MOD)

JIANG NAN ITEM RETENTION — DO NOT USE	
Item Name:	**Date / Time Collected:**
Batch No.:	**Collected By:**
Retention End By:	**Manager on Duty**

Figure 1. Item Retention Tag

7.2. Packaging Standard

All retention samples must be **packaged immediately after collection to protect the sample from contamination, leakage, and exposure**. The following packaging requirements must be followed:

- Use only approved food-grade PE plastic for packaging retention samples.
- Ensure the packaging is clean, intact, and suitable for food contact.
- Place the sample securely inside the PE plastic packaging.
- Tightly seal the sample using an approved vacuum sealer to prevent leakage, contamination,and exposure to air.
- Ensure that the seal is complete and secure, with no openings, tears, or leaks.
- Do not use damaged, previously used, or unapproved packaging materials.

7.3. Storage Temperature and Location

All retention samples must be stored under the appropriate temperature condition immediately after packaging to maintain the integrity and safety of the sample. The following storage requirements must be followed:

- Refrigerated items must be stored at 4°C (40°F) or below using sterile, leak-proof, food-grade PE plastic packaging that is tightly vacuum-sealed.
- Frozen items must be stored at -18°C (0°F) or below using sterile, leak-proof, food-grade PE plastic packaging that is tightly vacuum-sealed.
- Ensure that refrigerated and frozen retention samples are stored in their designated storage areas to prevent cross-contamination and improper storage.
- Do not store refrigerated samples in frozen storage or frozen samples under refrigeration, unless specifically required by the product's storage requirements.
- Monitor and maintain the required storage temperature throughout the retention period.

7.4. Retention Period

All retention samples must be kept for a designated period to allow proper investigation and verification in case of food safety concerns or customer complaints. The following retention period must be followed:

- All retention samples must be retained for a minimum of 5 days and a maximum of 7 days.
- The retention period must be counted from the date and time the sample is collected.
- Samples must remain properly sealed, labeled, and stored at the required temperature throughout the retention period.

- After the required retention period has been completed, the retention sample must be properly disposed of according to the waste disposal procedures.

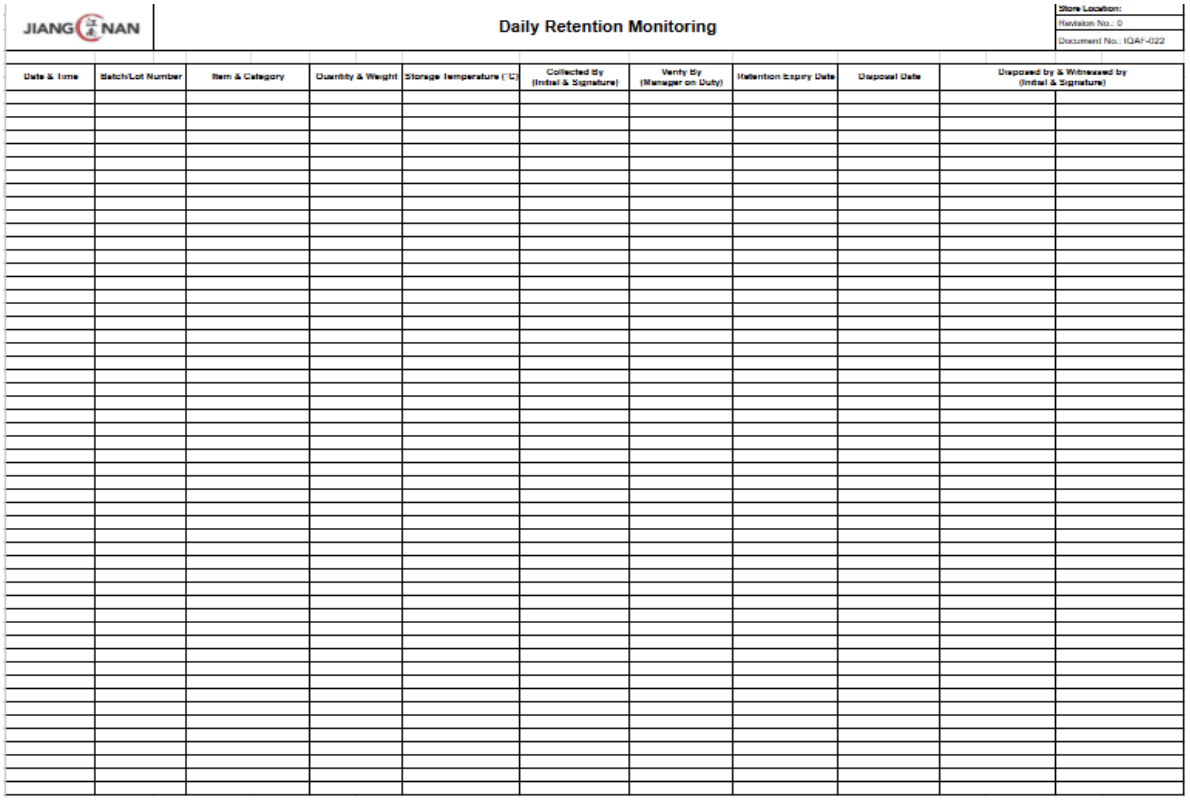
7.5. Disposal

Upon reaching the end of the required retention period, the retention sample must automatically be considered wastage and disposed of properly. The following disposal procedures must be followed:

- Check the retention date and time to confirm that the required retention period has been completed.
- Record the disposed retention sample in the "Daily RetentionMonitoring."
- Properly identify the sample as wastage before disposal.
- Open and dispose of the retention sample according to the proper waste segregation management.
- Separate food waste, plastic packaging, and other waste materials according to the designated waste segregation categories.
- Ensure that the disposal of the retention sample is properly documented in the *"Daily Retention Monitoring"* for traceability purposes.
- ***Do not consume, reuse, or return*** expired retention samples to production or service.

8. Documentation

A physical monitoring form must be completed daily, recording every item retention.The monitoring form must capture: date & time, batch/lot number, item & category, quantity & weight, storage temperature, employee name who collected the retention, and, upon disposal date disposed, staff who disposed of it, and supervisor counter signature.



JIANG NAN

Daily Retention Monitoring

Store Location:
Revision No.: 0
Document No.: IQAF-022

Date & Time	Batch/Lot Number	Item & Category	Quantity & Weight	Storage Temperature (°C)	Collected By (Initial & Signature)	Verify By (Manager on Duty)	Retention Expiry Date	Disposal Date	Disposed by & Witnessed by (Initial & Signature)	

Figure 2. Daily Retention Monitoring

9. Corrective Action

Failure to comply with the protocols undermines the safety of our guests and the company's legal compliance.

- **Minor Violations:** First-time behavioral infractions (e.g., mislabeled bag, late collection within the same operational day, minor log completeness errors) will re-labeling or sample re-collection result in immediate on-the-spot correction by Restaurant and Shift Managers.
- **Major or Repeated Violations:** Intentional non-compliance, falsification of logs, or repeated failures to execute critical safety measures (e.g. Omission of required food samples, storing samples above -18°C, sample log falsification, or repeated minor infractions.) will formal disciplinary action and mandatory retraining partnership with L&D within 48 hours.

10. Training and Verification

All store employees must complete retention-sample training before this SOP takes effect at their branch, with L&D developing the training plan, designing content and preparing all materials and handouts, coordinating with Operations Management and attending employees, conducting the training, including a post-test assessment to evaluate understanding of the topic and maintaining a signed training-completion record per employee, while QA verifies the training content and materials prior to rollout of the actual training.

11. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	September 8, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	Originator

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
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